

Pocket Jockey

Music on the go, tiny, in your pocket, and with high fidelity sound—the portable media players available today are hard to choose from. Let us help

Michael Browne

Music is the harmonious voice of creation; an echo of the invisible world.

Thus spake Giuseppe Mazzini, Italian patriot, philosopher and politician once said. Come to think of it music is the universal idiom that transcends all boundaries, man-made or otherwise. In fact music has bridged unfathomable opposites, and is truly a universal language irrespective of its creator.

It's also been said that the history of a people is found in their song. While quotes on music can run several pages, perhaps even longer than this article, the point is nearly all of us are into music, in some form or the other.

The phrase "listening to music" is synonymous with a comfortable couch, a decent music player and perhaps most significantly, spare time. The hum-

ble portable media player (often, but incorrectly, called the MP3 player) owes its origins to the lack of the latter in this day and age.

Today, Portable Media Players (PMPs) aren't just about a passion for music or seeking a temporary haven from noise, but a fashion statement. In fact, many PMPs are designed ground-up as a nice extension of your wardrobe, be it formal and suave, or let-your-hair-down casual. They also aren't just the tiny jukeboxes they were originally meant to be. Like any technology product of the past five years or so, they've matured into user-friendly, infinitely customisable devices. It's not uncommon to find a PMP that allows you to tune in to FM radio channels, maintain contacts and appointments and even play games when you're bored, or watch a movie!

This time we did a market survey and hand-picked PMPs that we felt would suit every possible audience among our readers—for different budgets. We covered 13 brands, and looked at PMPs suitable for mobile

